

FOR GPs AND REFERRING CLINICIANS

A specialist-led pathway for your complex metabolic patients.

Meridian Health is a multidisciplinary bariatric metabolic surgery practice. Our team provides comprehensive assessment, evidence-based surgical and medical management, and long-term follow-up for patients with chronic metabolic disease.

REFERRAL CONTACT

BY PHONE

(03) 9416 4418

Monday to Friday, 8:30am to 5:00pm

BY EMAIL

reception@meridianhealth.com.au

ONLINE

meridianhealth.com.au/contact/

A GP referral is helpful but not required for initial enquiry. Our team will contact your patient within one business day to arrange assessment.

THE PRACTICE

Anchored in a world-class clinical precinct.

Meridian Health operates from the Aitkenhead Medical Discovery Precinct at Brenan Place, Melbourne, alongside St Vincent's Private Hospital. Consulting, diagnostics and hospital services are integrated within the same precinct, creating continuity across the referral arc.

The referring GP receives a written summary following every assessment and remains an active part of the patient's care record.

Our multi-disciplinary team delivers bariatric metabolic surgery outcomes that are among the most durable in chronic metabolic disease management. BMI alone is not the determinant of candidacy; metabolic burden and long-term trajectory are the primary clinical considerations.

REFERRAL CRITERIA

Who to refer

Consider a Meridian referral for patients presenting with any of the following clinical profiles.

Type 2 Diabetes with Medication Escalation

Long-standing T2DM with poor glycaemic control despite multiple agents; HbA1c persistently above 7.5%; patients who have not achieved remission through lifestyle or pharmacological intervention.

Elevated Metabolic and Cardiovascular Risk

BMI 35 or above with one or more metabolic comorbidities; BMI 30 to 35 with severe insulin resistance, cardiovascular risk, or metabolic syndrome. BMI alone is not the determinant of candidacy.

GLP-1 Plateau or Cessation

Patients whose GLP-1 pharmacotherapy has plateaued, is unsustainable long-term, or has been ceased with significant weight and metabolic recurrence.

Complex Obesity with Failed Conservative Management

Patients who have made sustained lifestyle effort over two or more years without durable metabolic benefit and are seeking a definitive, evidence-based intervention.

THE EVIDENCE

T2DM remission rates in appropriately selected surgical patients exceed those of any pharmacological intervention at the five-year mark.

Long-term weight loss maintenance is superior to every non-surgical intervention at both the five and ten-year marks.

All-cause cardiovascular mortality is meaningfully reduced in surgical patients versus matched non-surgical controls.

MDT ASSESSMENT

What every referred patient receives.

No surgical decision is made before the full MDT review is complete. The assessment is a clinical process, not a commitment to surgery.

The referring GP receives a written summary of all assessment findings and is invited to provide clinical context at any stage.

- 01

Surgical Consultation
Specialist assessment including full clinical history, surgical candidacy review, and discussion of procedure options where appropriate.
- 02

Seca Body Composition Analysis
Medical-grade measurement of skeletal muscle mass, visceral fat, bone mineral density, and metabolic phase angle.
- 03

Dietitian Review
Nutritional assessment and pre-operative optimisation with a protocol tailored to the patient's surgical pathway and metabolic profile.
- 04

Psychological Readiness Evaluation
Structured readiness assessment to confirm preparedness for the pre- and post-operative process, including behavioural support needs.
- 05

Written Care Plan
A complete, patient-reviewed plan covering the surgical pathway, post-operative follow-up, and long-term monitoring schedule. A copy is shared with the referring GP.

OUTCOMES SNAPSHOT

Indicative twelve-month outcomes

T2DM patient, post bariatric metabolic surgery

HbA1c 8.4% to 5.9% Returned to normal range	Medications 4 agents to 2 Continuing to taper	Blood Pressure 138/88 to 118/76 Normalised	Triglycerides 3.2 to 1.1 mmol/L Within normal range
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Representative patient outcomes. Individual results vary. Published with patient consent. Long-term monitoring maintained for all surgical patients.

FOR THE CONVERSATION WITH YOUR PATIENT

What to tell them before the referral.

- This is a specialist consultation, not a commitment to surgery. The assessment determines candidacy; no surgical decision is made before the MDT review is complete.
- Bariatric metabolic surgery is not a procedure of last resort. It is the most evidence-supported long-term intervention available for complex metabolic disease.
- Meridian's care does not end at surgery. Patients remain under active team care through twelve-month follow-up, with the referring GP kept informed throughout.
- Medicare rebates may apply where eligible services are provided under a valid referral. Our team will clarify eligibility at the initial assessment.

THE CARE TEAM

- **A/Prof Michael Hii, Bariatric Metabolic Surgeon • FRACS**

Fellowship-trained specialist surgeon leading surgical candidacy review, procedure planning, and the written care plan shared with the referring GP.

- **Dr Salena Ward, Bariatric Surgeon • FRACS**

Pre- and post-operative nutritional assessment, optimisation, and ongoing dietary support throughout the care continuum.

- **Dr Nicole Winter, Bariatric Surgeon • FRACS**

Clinical coordination, pre-admission management, and the primary point of contact for patients between appointments.

The referring GP receives a written summary following the initial assessment and remains an active part of the patient's care record. We

HOW TO REFER

Send us a referral.

You can refer by phone, email, or via our online enquiry form. A clinician will review the referral and contact your patient within one business day to arrange an initial assessment appointment.

If you would like to discuss clinical candidacy before referring, call the practice directly. We welcome conversations with GPs before the patient is seen.

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Secure enquiry form. Reply within one business day.

*welcome direct conversations about patient
candidacy before referral.*

Meridian Health · Brenan Place, Aitkenhead Medical Discovery Precinct,
Melbourne

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